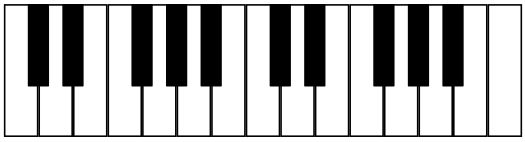
Read at Sight

A graded sight-reading course for piano

Volume 7A - Repertoire, Levels 7-8



Middle C

45 complete pieces by the great keyboard composers,
from Bach to Debussy and Joplin, to learn and keep.

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How to use this book

What this book is

Volumes 1-6 taught you to read. This book is music to learn and keep: complete pieces, not exercises. Each one will take from a few days to a few weeks. Every piece is printed in full, exactly as its composer wrote it.

Levels

Each piece has a level. Level 7 pieces can be learned in days after Volume 6; Level 8 pieces take a week or two (faster passages, wider stretches, pedal and voicing matter). Book 7B continues with Levels 9 and 10. The index at the back lists this book's pieces by level: a suggested order.

How to learn a piece

1. Read it through once at sight, slowly, without stopping, to hear what it is. 2. Find the hard places and learn them first, hands separately, then together, slowly with a metronome. 3. Learn the piece in sections of four to eight bars, joining each to the next. 4. Raise the speed in small steps; never faster than you can play evenly. 5. Then play it for someone. A piece is learned when you can play it steadily after a day away from it.

Keep reading

Do not stop sight-reading while you learn these pieces. Ten minutes a day of new music at Level 6-7 keeps your reading growing: hymns, chorales, easier pieces by the composers in this book.

The sources

The scores were engraved by volunteers of the Mutopia Project and are public domain or Creative Commons. The note above each piece names its source; the last page lists them all with their licences.

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Section 1
Baroque

Music from about 1600 to 1750, written for the harpsichord, clavichord and organ: instruments with no sustaining pedal and little or no change of loudness from the touch. Its keyboard music is woven from independent lines. In an invention or a fugue each hand carries its own voice, the same motive passes from one to the other, and the interest is in how the lines answer each other. Dances (gavotte, bourree, minuet) and preludes built on broken chords are the other two families here.

What it asks of you

Independent hands: each voice shaped as if it were sung, with its own phrasing. Articulation instead of pedal: detach most eighths, slur most sixteenths, and use little or no pedal. A steady pulse, and ornaments (trills, mordents) played on the beat, starting on the note above unless the score says otherwise.

In this section

J. S. Bach: Little Prelude in D minor, BWV 926 *(Level 7)*
J. S. Bach: Little Prelude in C, BWV 933 *(Level 7)*
J. S. Bach: Invention No. 1 in C, BWV 772 *(Level 7)*
J. S. Bach: Invention No. 4 in D minor, BWV 775 *(Level 7)*
J. S. Bach: Invention No. 8 in F, BWV 779 *(Level 7)*
J. S. Bach: Invention No. 13 in A minor, BWV 784 *(Level 8)*
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J. S. Bach: Aria from the Goldberg Variations, BWV 988 *(Level 8)*
G. F. Handel: Air with Variations in F *(Level 7)*
D. Scarlatti: Sonata in C minor, K. 11 *(Level 8)*
J.-P. Rameau: Tambourin in E minor *(Level 8)*

Little Prelude in D minor, BWV 926

J. S. Bach (1685-1750) - Clavier-Büchlein for Wilhelm Friedemann Bach

Level 7 · about 2 min

One of the short preludes Bach wrote into the lesson book he began in 1720 for his ten-year-old son, Wilhelm Friedemann. The right hand plays broken chords in sixteenths over a bass in quarter notes, and the harmony changes about once a bar: learn each bar's chord shape first. Keep the sixteenths even and hold the bass notes for their full length.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 69, typeset by Allen Garvin (public domain).




29
35
40
44

Little Prelude in C, BWV 933

J. S. Bach (1685-1750) - Six Little Preludes, No. 1

Level 7 · about 2 min

The first of the Six Little Preludes, which survive in copies made by Bach's pupils. Two voices in two halves, each repeated. The ornaments (mordents and trills) belong to the line: play them lightly and on the beat.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 1537, typeset by Hajo Dezelski (CC BY-SA 3.0).




12
14

Invention No. 1 in C, BWV 772

J. S. Bach (1685-1750) - Fifteen Two-Part Inventions (1723)

Level 7 · about 2 min

Bach wrote the Inventions to teach 'a singing style of playing' and how to develop one idea. The short motive of the first bar passes between the hands, upside down as often as right way up, for all 22 bars. Find and bring out each entry of the motive; detach the eighths, keep the sixteenths smooth.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 40, typeset by jeff covey (CC BY-SA 3.0).




13
15
17
20

Invention No. 4 in D minor, BWV 775

J. S. Bach (1685-1750) - Fifteen Two-Part Inventions (1723)

Level 7 · about 2 min

A quick invention in 3/8: a running sixteenth-note figure in one hand against long held notes, some with trills, in the other. Hold the long notes for their full value while the other hand runs, and keep one beat to the bar.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 67, typeset by Allen Garvin (public domain).




35
41
47

Invention No. 8 in F, BWV 779

J. S. Bach (1685-1750) - Fifteen Two-Part Inventions (1723)

Level 7 · about 2 min

A canon to begin with: the left hand plays the right hand's leaping broken-chord tune one bar later and an octave lower. Light, detached eighths and even sixteenths; never faster than the sixteenths can stay even.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 61, typeset by Allen Garvin (public domain).




19
22
25
28
31

Invention No. 13 in A minor, BWV 784

J. S. Bach (1685-1750) - Fifteen Two-Part Inventions (1723)

Level 8 · about 2 min

Broken chords in sixteenths over a bass in eighths, then the hands swap roles. The harmony moves in long chains of chords; learning the chord of each half bar makes the patterns easy to read and to remember.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 59, typeset by Allen Garvin (public domain).




13
15
17
19
21
23

Sinfonia No. 2 in C minor, BWV 788

J. S. Bach (1685-1750) - Fifteen Three-Part Sinfonias (1723)

Level 8 · about 3 min

The Sinfonias are the harder companions of the Inventions: three voices for two hands. The flowing 12/8 subject enters in each voice in turn; the middle voice moves between the hands, as in Volume 6, Unit 1. Hold every tied note exactly.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 140, typeset by Olivier Vermersch (public domain).




11
13
15
17
19
21


23
25
27
29
31

Prelude in C, BWV 846

J. S. Bach (1685-1750) - The Well-Tempered Clavier, Book 1, No. 1 (1722)

Level 7 · about 2 min

One broken-chord pattern, the same in every bar, through 35 bars of harmony. Play each bar as a chord first to learn the progression, then let the pattern flow, perfectly even, with the pedal changed every bar or not at all. Gounod later wrote his Ave Maria as a melody above it.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 5, typeset by Tobias Erbsland (public domain).




13
15
17
19
21
23
25


27
29
31
33

Prelude in C minor, BWV 847

J. S. Bach (1685-1750) - The Well-Tempered Clavier, Book 1, No. 2 (1722)

Level 8 · about 2 min

Both hands in sixteenths in a pattern that hardly changes, until the music breaks into a Presto, a short Adagio like a recitative, and a final Allegro. Practise the pattern slowly hands together from the start, and keep strict time until the tempo changes.

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14
16
18
20
22
24
26


28
Presto
30
32
34
Adagio
35
Allegro
37

Gavotte in G, BWV 816

J. S. Bach (1685-1750) - French Suite No. 5

Level 7 · about 1 min

A gavotte is a French court dance in cut time that starts in the middle of the bar. This one comes from the most popular of Bach's six French Suites: a cheerful tune over a walking bass. Detach the quarter notes and slur the eighths lightly, two by two.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 99, typeset by Joel Mayes (public domain).



Aria from the Goldberg Variations, BWV 988

J. S. Bach (1685-1750) - Goldberg Variations (1741)

Level 8 · about 3 min

The theme of Bach's thirty Goldberg Variations: a slow sarabande with a richly ornamented melody over a simple bass. The bass line, not the melody, is what the variations are built on. Learn the melody without ornaments first, then add them one at a time.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 979, typeset by JD Erickson (CC BY-SA 3.0).




21
24
27
30

Air with Variations in F

G. F. Handel (1685-1759) - Aylesford Pieces

Level 7 · about 2 min

From the Aylesford Pieces, keyboard music by Handel preserved in manuscript copies. A short air followed by variations that keep its harmony and add faster notes. Keep one steady pulse from the air to the end.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 165, typeset by Bas Wassink (public domain).




25
6
29
33
1.
2.

Sonata in C minor, K. 11

D. Scarlatti (1685-1757) - Essercizi per gravicembalo (1738)

Level 8 · about 3 min

Domenico Scarlatti, Bach's exact contemporary, wrote 555 keyboard sonatas; the thirty Essercizi were the only ones he published. Like most of them it is one movement in two halves, each repeated. Decide the fingering of every run in advance and keep the touch light and clear.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 141, typeset by Bas Wassink (public domain).




14
1.
2.
tr
17
20
22
24
26
28

Tambourin in E minor

J.-P. Rameau (1683-1764) - Pièces de clavecin (1724)

Level 8 · about 2 min

A tambourin is a dance from Provence played on pipe and drum: the left hand imitates the drum with its repeated notes, the right hand the pipe. It is a rondeau: the opening tune returns between two episodes. Lively and strictly in time.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 487, typeset by Ludovic Sardain (public domain).




30
35
41
47
53
57

Section 2
Classical

Music from about 1750 to 1820, written for the new fortepiano, whose touch could play loud and soft (hence its name). Haydn, Mozart and the young Beethoven write a singing tune over a simple accompaniment, in clear phrases of four and eight bars, and build movements from contrasting themes: sonata form, rondo, minuet and trio, variations.

What it asks of you

Clean, even passagework (scales and broken chords exactly in time), a light accompaniment under a clear melody (Alberti basses quieter than the tune), and contrasts of loud and soft made by touch. Use the pedal sparingly, to join harmonies, not to blur scales.

In this section

J. Haydn: Sonata in G, Hob. XVI:27: III. Presto *(Level 8)*
W. A. Mozart: Sonata in C, K. 545: I. Allegro *(Level 7)*
W. A. Mozart: Sonata in C, K. 545: II. Andante *(Level 7)*
W. A. Mozart: Sonata in C, K. 545: III. Rondo *(Level 8)*
W. A. Mozart: Fantasia in D minor, K. 397 *(Level 8)*
L. van Beethoven: Für Elise *(Level 7)*
L. van Beethoven: Sonata in G, Op. 49 No. 2: I. Allegro ma non troppo *(Level 7)*
L. van Beethoven: Sonata in G, Op. 49 No. 2: II. Tempo di menuetto *(Level 7)*
L. van Beethoven: "Moonlight" Sonata, Op. 27 No. 2: I. Adagio sostenuto *(Level 8)*
L. van Beethoven: "Pathétique" Sonata, Op. 13: II. Adagio cantabile *(Level 8)*

Sonata in G, Hob. XVI:27: III. Presto

J. Haydn (1732-1809) - Six Sonatas (1776)

Level 8 · about 3 min

The finale of the first of the six sonatas Haydn published in 1776. Quick and witty: detach the eighths, play the sixteenths crisply, use no pedal, and enjoy the sudden pauses.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 187, typeset by Bas Wassink (public domain).




43
50
56
62
68
74


82
90
98
105
110
116


122
127
133
140
146

Sonata in C, K. 545: I. Allegro

W. A. Mozart (1756-1791) - Piano Sonata 'facile' (1788)

Level 7 · about 4 min

Mozart listed it as 'a little piano sonata for beginners'; it is known as the Sonata facile. A model sonata form, with one surprise: the return of the first theme comes in F major, not C. Its scales and broken chords must be perfectly even; practise them slowly with a metronome.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 998, typeset by Alejandro Sierra (CC BY-SA 3.0).




12
p
mp
15
mp
mp
17
19
21
p
23
f
sf


25
27
30
32
34
36
sf


38
sf
40
sf
42
mp
p
45
tr
47
49


51
53
55
57
60
62
p
f
mp
mp
p
mp


64
66
69
71
p
p
f
tr

Sonata in C, K. 545: II. Andante

W. A. Mozart (1756-1791) - Piano Sonata 'facile' (1788)

Level 7 · about 4 min

A singing melody over an Alberti bass that hardly stops. Keep the left hand soft and even under the tune and shape each four-bar phrase; the middle section moves to G minor.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 1007, typeset by Alejandro Sierra (CC BY-SA 3.0).




16
p
pp
19
22
mf
25
p
mf
mp
28
mp
p
31
p


35
38
mp
p
41
44
p
47
p
pp
pp
50


53
56
mp
p
59
mf
mp
p
62
p
65
mf
mf
p
68
f
mf
71
mf

Sonata in C, K. 545: III. Rondo

W. A. Mozart (1756-1791) - Piano Sonata 'facile' (1788)

Level 8 · about 2 min

A short, light rondo: its theme is answered in imitation between the hands. Crisp sixteenths and clear staccato; no pedal.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 1027, typeset by Alejandro Sierra (CC BY-SA 3.0).




26
mf
mf
mp
p
p
mp
31
p
mp
35
39
mp
p
mp
p
44
mp


48
53
59
64
69

Fantasia in D minor, K. 397

W. A. Mozart (1756-1791)

Level 8 · about 6 min

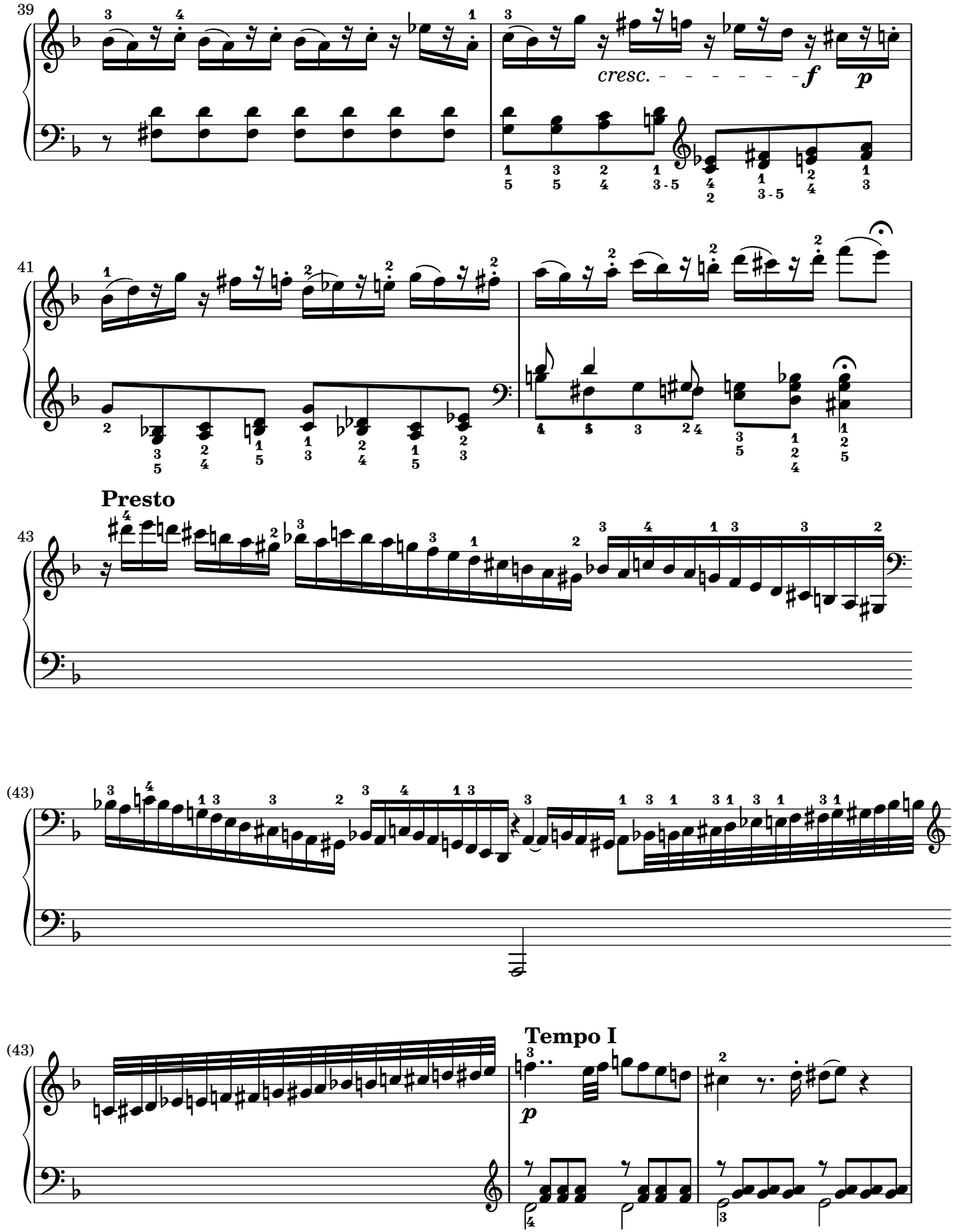
Left unfinished at Mozart's death; the last ten bars were probably added by the first publisher. It moves from a dark arpeggio introduction through a sighing Adagio, broken by sudden outbursts and Presto runs, to a bright Allegretto in D major. The fermatas and runs may be played freely; the rest in strict time.

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Adagio
12
p
15
f
p
18
f
21
p
24


26
cresc.
f
p
cresc.
f
28
p
31
cresc.
f
Presto
34
(34)
Tempo I
f
36
p


39
cresc.
f
p
41
Presto
43
(43)
(43)
Tempo I
p


45
48
51
52
58
Allegreto
dolce


64
1.
2.
69
73
78
83


(84)
rall.
a tempo
86
f
p
92
f
p
pp
99
f
ff

Für Elise

L. van Beethoven (1770-1827) - Bagatelle in A minor, WoO 59 (1810)

Level 7 · about 3 min

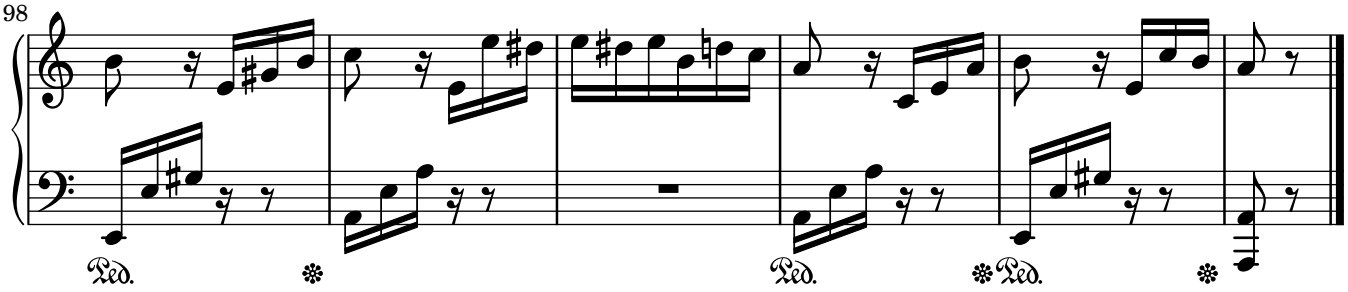
Written in 1810 but not published until 1867, forty years after Beethoven's death. It is a rondo: the famous tune returns between a sunny episode in F major and a stormy one over a repeated A in the bass. Keep the left-hand broken chords light and even, and change the pedal where marked.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 931, typeset by Stelios Samelis (public domain).




25
30
34
40
Ped.
46
Ped.
52
58


64
70
76
8
pp
Ped.
81
Ped.
86
Ped.
92
Ped.


98
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.

Sonata in G, Op. 49 No. 2: I. Allegro ma non troppo

L. van Beethoven (1770-1827) - Two Easy Sonatas, Op. 49

Level 7 · about 4 min

The two sonatas of Op. 49, written in the 1790s and published in 1805 as 'easy sonatas'. This first movement is a full sonata form in miniature: a first theme in G, a second theme in D with triplets, a short development and the return. Play the triplets exactly as triplets, not as dotted rhythms.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 776, typeset by Stelios Samelis (public domain).




30
35
39
43
47
51
55
59
f


63
67
72
76
80
84
88
93


98
103
107
111
115
119

Sonata in G, Op. 49 No. 2: II. Tempo di menuetto

L. van Beethoven (1770-1827) - Two Easy Sonatas, Op. 49

Level 7 · about 3 min

A graceful minuet in rondo form. Beethoven liked its tune so much that he used it again in the minuet of his Septet, Op. 20. Light, even staccato in the episodes; keep the minuet's three beats steady.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 777, typeset by Stelios Samelis (public domain).




24
28
f
31
34
38
3
3
3
42
46
pp


50
54
59
63
67
71
75


79
83
pp
87
91
95
100
104
p


108
112
116

"Moonlight" Sonata, Op. 27 No. 2: I. Adagio sostenuto

L. van Beethoven (1770-1827) - Sonata quasi una fantasia (1801)

Level 8 · about 6 min

Beethoven called it a 'sonata like a fantasy'; the name 'Moonlight' came from a critic after his death. Triplets flow through the whole movement under a slow melody in the top voice: the melody sings, the triplets stay soft. Beethoven asks for the pedal throughout: change it with every harmony.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 276, typeset by Stewart Holmes (CC BY-SA 2.5).




13
16
19
22
25
cresc.
descresc.


28
31
34
37
40
p
decresc.
pp


43
46
cresc.
49
52
55


58
cresc.
p
61
64
66
decresc.
pp
pp
attacca subito
il seguente

"Pathétique" Sonata, Op. 13: II. Adagio cantabile

L. van Beethoven (1770-1827) - Grande Sonate pathétique (1798)

Level 8 · about 5 min

One of Beethoven's best-loved melodies. The right hand plays both the tune and a soft middle voice in sixteenths: the fourth and fifth fingers sing the tune while the thumb keeps the accompaniment quiet. Learn the melody alone first.

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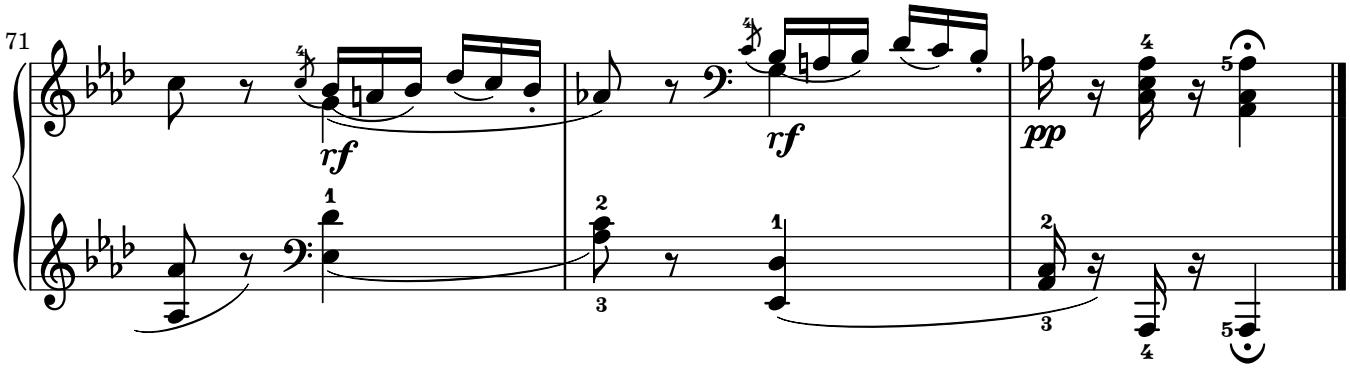



13
16
19
22
25
cresc.
(m.s.)
cresc.
p
pp


29
p
33
36
pp
39
cresc.
42
sf
sf
sf


44
fp
decresc.
pp
46
48
50
cresc.
p
53


56
59
62
65
pp
68
rf


71
rf
rf
pp

Section 3
Early Romantic

The first half of the nineteenth century: Schubert, Field, Mendelssohn, Schumann and Chopin. The piano becomes bigger and richer, and composers write short character pieces (nocturnes, songs without words, preludes, waltzes, impromptus) that express one mood. The melody sings like a voice over wide-spread accompaniment held together by the pedal.

What it asks of you

A singing tone: weight into the keys for the melody, a soft accompaniment. Pedal changed with each harmony (press it just after the new chord, not with it). Rubato that bends the time but keeps the left hand steady. Wide left-hand leaps, found by looking ahead, not at the hands.

In this section

- F. Schubert: Moment musical No. 3 in F minor, D. 780 *(Level 7)*
- F. Schubert: Impromptu in A-flat, D. 935 No. 2 *(Level 8)*
- J. Field: Nocturne No. 5 in B-flat, H. 37 *(Level 8)*
- F. Mendelssohn: Venetian Gondola Song in G minor, Op. 19 No. 6 *(Level 8)*
- F. Mendelssohn: Venetian Gondola Song in F-sharp minor, Op. 30 No. 6 *(Level 8)*
- R. Schumann: Of Foreign Lands and Peoples, Op. 15 No. 1 *(Level 7)*
- R. Schumann: Träumerei (Dreaming), Op. 15 No. 7 *(Level 7)*
- F. Chopin: Prelude in E minor, Op. 28 No. 4 *(Level 7)*
- F. Chopin: Prelude in B minor, Op. 28 No. 6 *(Level 7)*
- F. Chopin: Prelude in A, Op. 28 No. 7 *(Level 7)*
- F. Chopin: Prelude in D-flat 'Raindrop', Op. 28 No. 15 *(Level 8)*
- F. Chopin: Waltz in B minor, Op. 69 No. 2 *(Level 8)*
- F. Chopin: Nocturne in E-flat, Op. 9 No. 2 *(Level 8)*

Moment musical No. 3 in F minor, D. 780

F. Schubert (1797-1828) - Six Moments musicaux (1823-1828)

Level 7 · about 2 min

The best known of Schubert's six Moments musicaux, first published in 1823 as 'Air russe'. A little dance over a staccato left hand that never stops. Keep it light and do not hurry.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 1023, typeset by Claude Chaudron (public domain).




26
31
36
41
47
53


58
63
ppp
dim.
68
dim.
73

Impromptu in A-flat, D. 935 No. 2

F. Schubert (1797-1828) - Four Impromptus, D. 935 (1827)

Level 8 · about 7 min

A gentle piece in 3/4 like a slow minuet, with a flowing trio in D-flat in triplets. Voice the chords of the main section so that the top line sings, and keep the triplets of the trio even and quiet.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 1195, typeset by Ph. Raynaud (public domain).




32
40
47
51
55
decresc.
pp
59
f
decresc.


63
8
cresc.
67
8
ff
fz
fz
71
fz
fz
fz
fz
fz
75
p
decresc.
tr
79
cresc.
decresc.


83
cresc.
decresc.
87
decresc.
pp
91
decresc.
95
sempre ligato
pp
99
cresc.
decresc.
106
cresc.
decresc.


114
f
ff
121
ffz decresc.
p
pp
128
pp
cresc.
decresc.
135
cresc.
142
decresc.
cresc.
ritard.
p

Nocturne No. 5 in B-flat, H. 37

J. Field (1782-1837)

Level 8 · about 4 min

John Field, an Irish pianist who made his career in Russia, invented the nocturne: a singing melody over wide, pedalled left-hand arpeggios. Chopin took the idea further. Learn the left hand alone until its leaps are secure and smooth.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 2137, typeset by Alex Schreiber (CC BY-SA 4.0).




16
sf
dim.
pp
19
cresc.
dim.
22
mf
p
25
28
8
pp


31
mf
Ped.
34
p
pp
p
37
40
pp
42
p
dim.
pp
ritard.

Venetian Gondola Song in G minor, Op. 19 No. 6

F. Mendelssohn (1809-1847) - Songs without Words, Book 1 (1830)

Level 8 · about 3 min

Mendelssohn's Songs without Words are piano pieces shaped like songs. In this one a gondolier sings over the rocking 6/8 of the boat; the left hand's bass-and-chord pattern must stay smooth and quiet throughout.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 1679, typeset by Ryan Prince (CC BY 3.0).




21
pp
Ped.
26
p
31
sfz
dim.
p
mf
sempre Ped
Ped.
36
dim.
pp
pp
41

Venetian Gondola Song in F-sharp minor, Op. 30 No. 6

F. Mendelssohn (1809-1847) - Songs without Words, Book 2 (1835)

Level 8 · about 3 min

The second of Mendelssohn's gondola songs: the melody, often in thirds and sixths, floats above a wide, rippling accompaniment, and near the end is decorated with trills. Practise the accompaniment alone with the pedal until it flows.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 1741, typeset by Ryan Prince (public domain).




26
più
f
ff
sfz
Ped.
31
dim.
pp
sfz
36
dim.
p
41
p
cresc.
f
46
dim.
p
cresc.
f
sfz
dim.
51
sfz
p
dim
pp

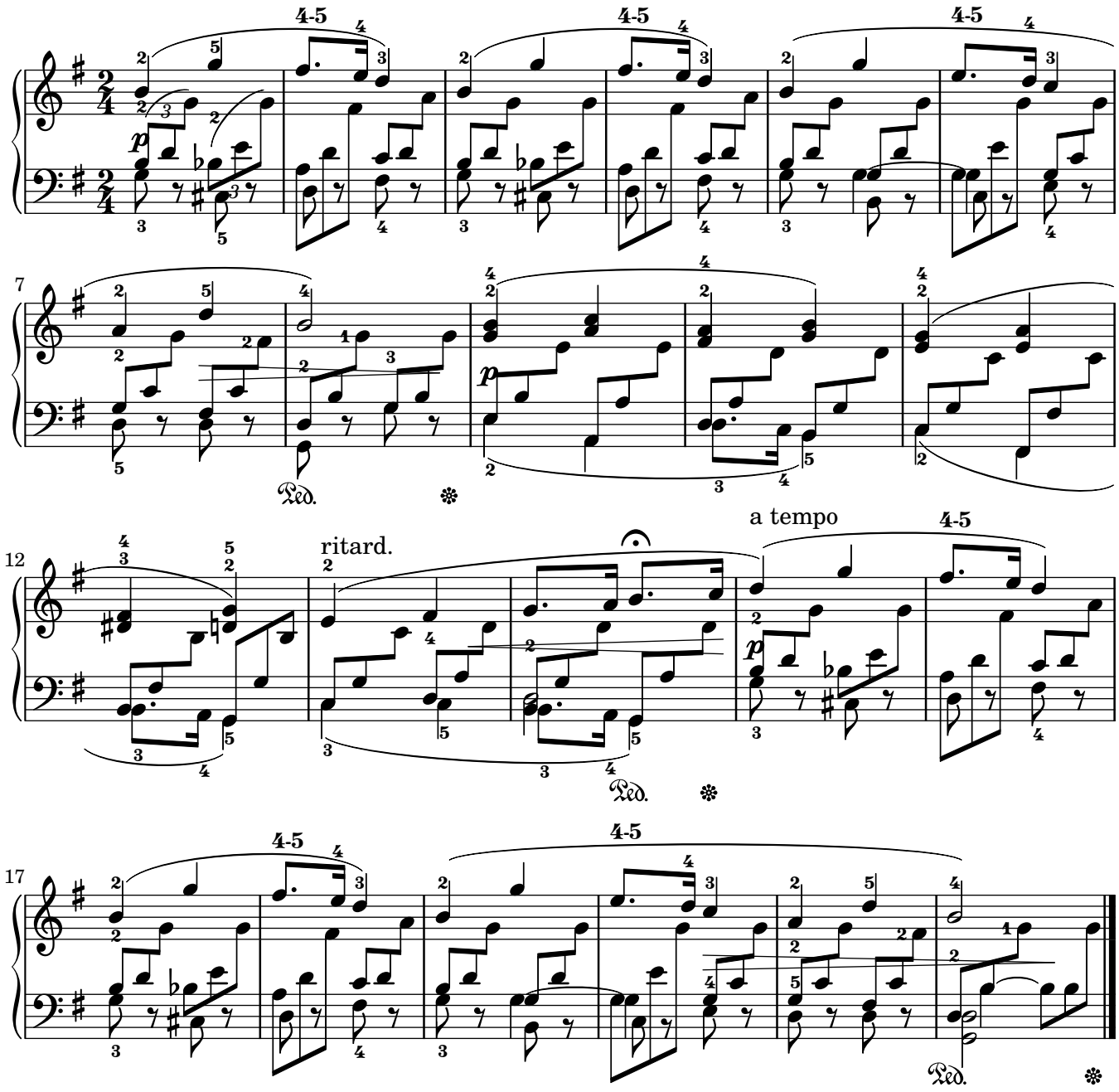
Of Foreign Lands and Peoples, Op. 15 No. 1

R. Schumann (1810-1856) - Scenes from Childhood (1838)

Level 7 · about 2 min

The first of Schumann's thirteen Scenes from Childhood, pieces about childhood for grown-up players. A simple tune over triplet broken chords that pass from hand to hand: the tune must stay on top.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 354, typeset by Ying-Chun Liu (public domain).



Träumerei (Dreaming), Op. 15 No. 7

R. Schumann (1810-1856) - Scenes from Childhood (1838)

Level 7 · about 3 min

One of the most famous pieces Schumann wrote. Four voices are shared between the hands; let the melody, which rises in each phrase, sing above the inner parts, and change the pedal with every harmony. Each phrase may slow a little at its end.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 504, typeset by Ying-Chun Liu (public domain).




13
ritard.
Ped.
17
(a tempo)
Ped.
Ped.
21
ritardando
p
Ped.
Ped.
Ped.

Prelude in E minor, Op. 28 No. 4

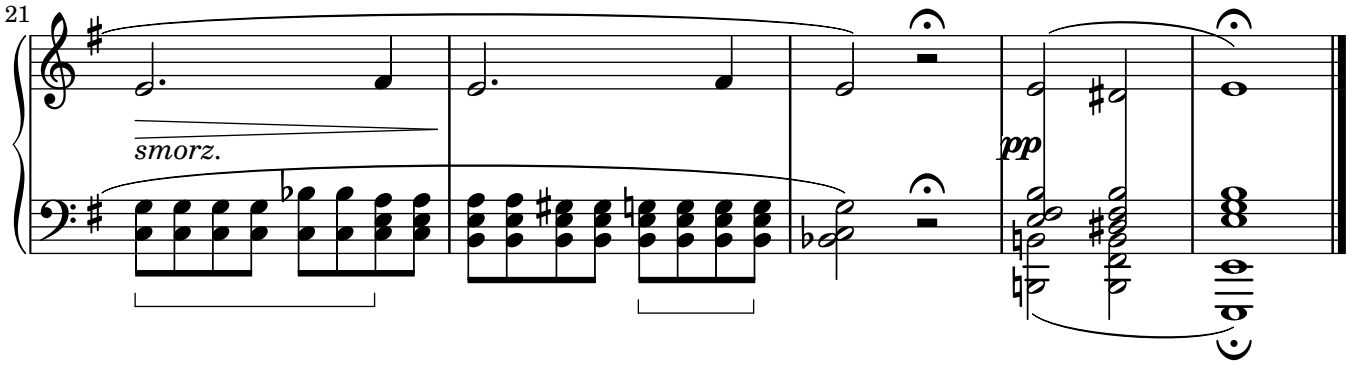
F. Chopin (1810-1849) - 24 Preludes, Op. 28 (1839)

Level 7 · about 2 min

Chopin's 24 Preludes pass through every major and minor key. In this one the melody hardly moves while the left-hand chords slide down by half steps beneath it: keep the chords soft and perfectly even. It was played at Chopin's funeral.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 468, typeset by Magnus Lewis-Smith (public domain).




21
smorz.
pp

Prelude in B minor, Op. 28 No. 6

F. Chopin (1810-1849) - 24 Preludes, Op. 28 (1839)

Level 7 · about 2 min

The melody is in the left hand, like a cello, under quiet repeated notes in the right. Let the left hand sing and keep the right hand in the background.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 469, typeset by Magnus Lewis-Smith (public domain).




19
pp
sostenuto
23
ppp

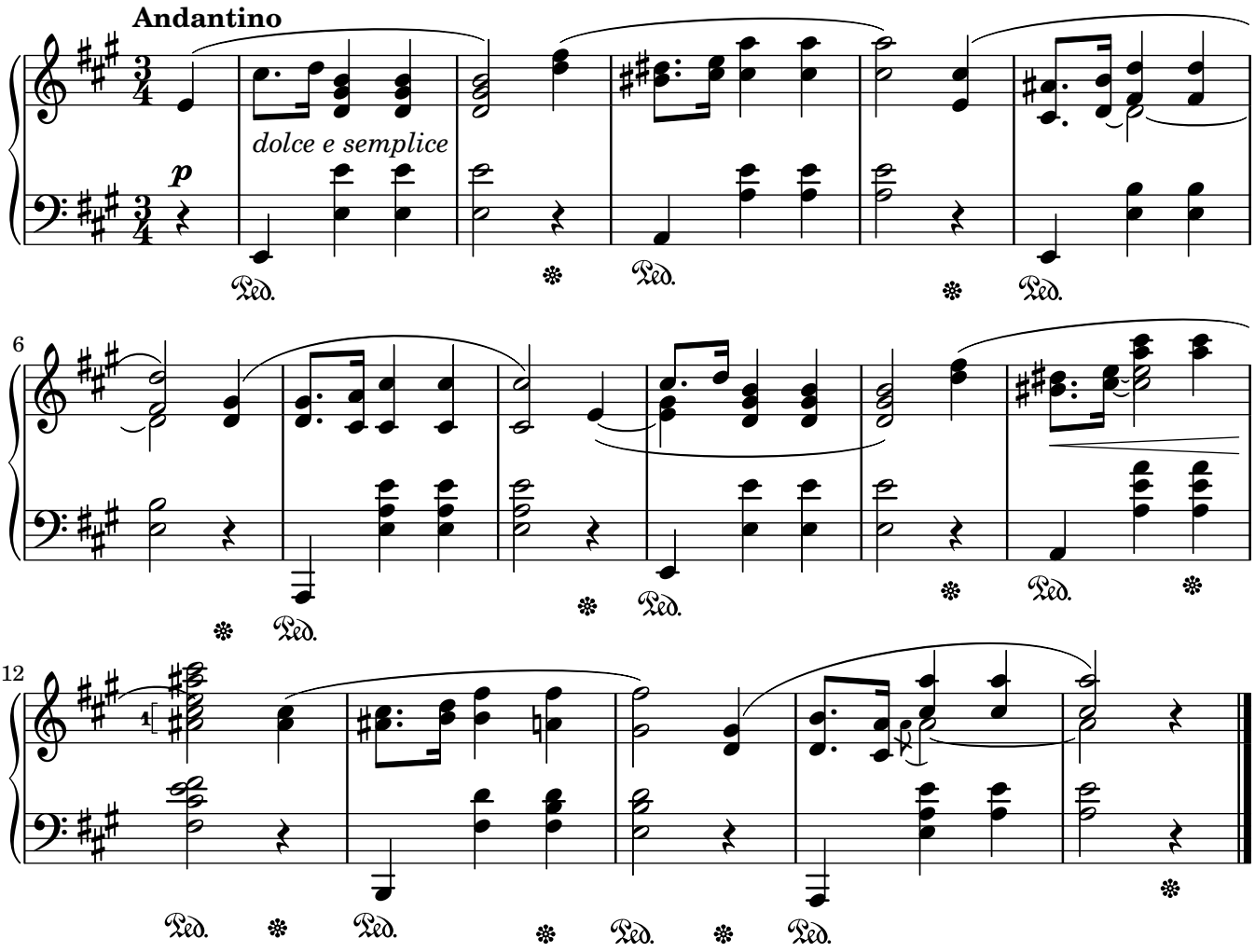
Prelude in A, Op. 28 No. 7

F. Chopin (1810-1849) - 24 Preludes, Op. 28 (1839)

Level 7 · about 1 min

Only sixteen bars: the same mazurka rhythm eight times over. Spread the large chord in bar 12 smoothly from the bottom, and keep the dotted rhythm gentle.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 470, typeset by Magnus Lewis-Smith (public domain).



Prelude in D-flat 'Raindrop', Op. 28 No. 15

F. Chopin (1810-1849) - 24 Preludes, Op. 28 (1839)

Level 8 · about 5 min

A repeated A-flat (G-sharp in the middle section) falls through the whole piece like rain. The dark middle section in C-sharp minor builds to a great climax and dies away; keep the repeated note quiet except where it is marked otherwise.

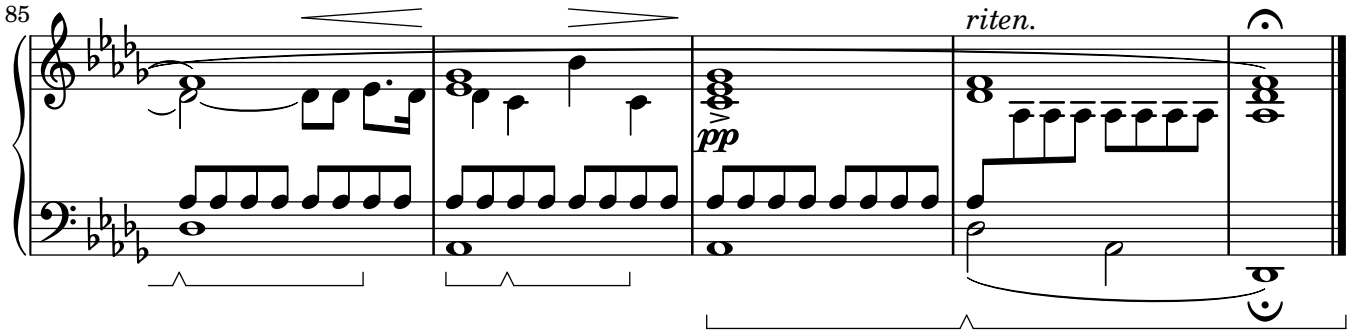
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21
Poco più animato
25
sotto voce
una corda
29
34
p
cresc.
tre corde
38
cresc.
ff
42
dim.
p
una corda


46
50
p cresc.
tre corde
54
cresc.
ff
58
fz dim.
p
62
p


66
p
70
f
74
dim.
poco rit.
p a tempo
77
10
smorzando
80
slentando
f
p


85
riten.
pp

Waltz in B minor, Op. 69 No. 2

F. Chopin (1810-1849)

Level 8 · about 3 min

Written in 1829 and published only after Chopin's death. A melancholy waltz with a trio in B major. Keep the left hand's bass-chord-chord light, with the bass held by the pedal, and let the melody lead the time.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 511, typeset by Roland Goretzki (public domain).




poco rit.
a tempo
dim.
con anima
rit.
a tempo
f
sf
sf


61
poco rit.
1.
a tempo
2.
a tempo
f
dim.
65
mf dolce
71
77
poco cresc.
dim.
mf
83


89
cresc.
dimin.
95
p
sf
f
101
p
107
cresc.
poco rit.
a tempo
dim.
113
con anima
120
rit.
a tempo


127
f
sf
sf
133
rit.
139
f
calando e
dimin.

Nocturne in E-flat, Op. 9 No. 2

F. Chopin (1810-1849) - Three Nocturnes, Op. 9 (1832)

Level 8 · about 4 min

Chopin's most famous nocturne. The melody returns three times, more decorated each time; play the ornaments as part of the singing line, without rushing them, over a smooth left hand of bass notes and chords.

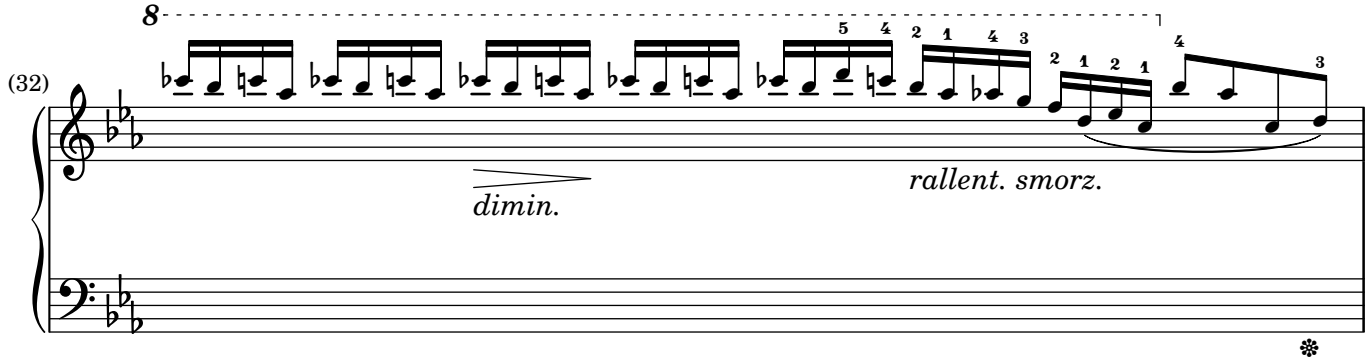
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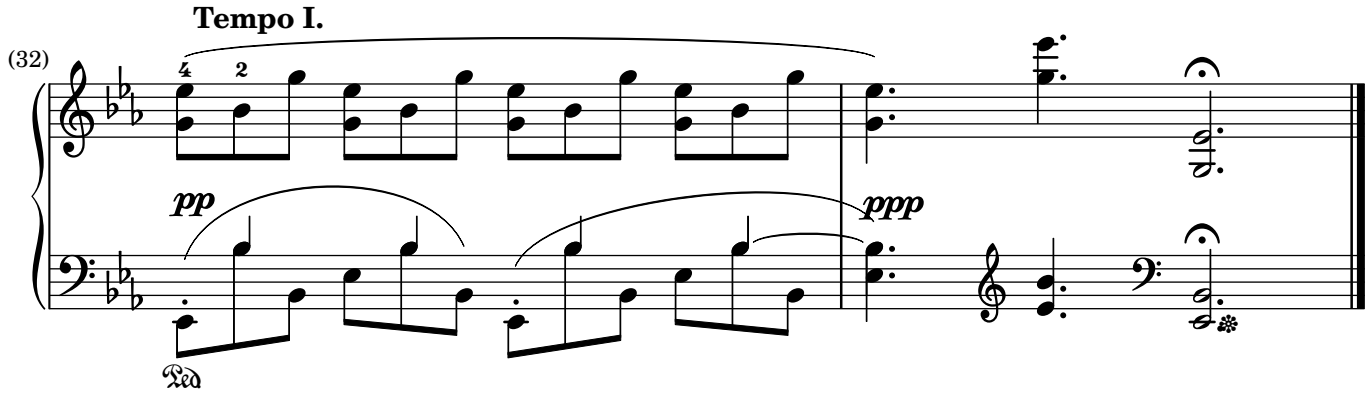



7
f
p
pp
Tempo I.
poco ritard.
10
f
poco rallent.
Tempo I.
13
sf
p
cresc.
15
p
(f)


17
p
(più p)
f
20
poco rall.
Tempo I.
sf
p
22
23
24
(f)
Coda
p


26
pp
poco rubato
sempre
pp
dolcissimo
28
8
p
30
con forza
tr
8
stretto
32
ff senza – –
tempo
cresc.


8
(32)
dimin.
rallent. smorz.


Tempo I.
(32)
pp
ppp
Ped

Section 4
Late Romantic

The second half of the nineteenth century: Brahms, Liszt, Grieg, Tchaikovsky, and at its end Scriabin and Rachmaninoff. The textures grow fuller and the harmony richer, and national styles (Grieg's Norwegian music, Tchaikovsky's Russian) join the German and French traditions.

What it asks of you

Full chords voiced to the top, longer phrases held together by the pedal, and steady control of building to a climax: a crescendo planned over many bars, not one.

In this section

J. Brahms: Waltz in A-flat, Op. 39 No. 15 *(Level 7)*

F. Liszt: Consolation No. 1 in E, S. 172 *(Level 8)*

E. Grieg: In the Hall of the Mountain King *(Level 8)*

Waltz in A-flat, Op. 39 No. 15

J. Brahms (1833-1897) - Sixteen Waltzes, Op. 39 (1865)

Level 7 · about 2 min

The best known of Brahms's sixteen waltzes, first written for piano duet and arranged by Brahms himself for one player. A gentle tune in thirds and sixths over a swaying bass.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 794, typeset by Brian D. Rude (public domain).




33
39

Consolation No. 1 in E, S. 172

F. Liszt (1811-1886) - Six Consolations (1849-1850)

Level 8 · about 2 min

The Consolations are Liszt's gentlest piano pieces. This first one is a short song with a hymn-like character: voice every chord to the top note and use the pedal to join the harmonies.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 1654, typeset by Ryan Prince (CC BY 3.0).



In the Hall of the Mountain King

E. Grieg (1843-1907) - Peer Gynt Suite No. 1, Op. 46 (piano version)

Level 8 · about 3 min

From Grieg's music for Ibsen's play Peer Gynt (1875), here for piano. One short tune is repeated over and over, louder and faster each time, to a wild ending. Start very quietly and strictly in time, and save your strength for the end.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 1888, typeset by Coyau (public domain).




22
26
Ped.
30
cresc.
34
38
42
mf
cresc.
3


45
Più vivo (♩ = 154)
8
ff
48
Ped.
8
52
8
56
sempre stretto sin al fine
8
60
8
64


68
8
72
8
sfz
sfz
Ped.
76
8
sfz
sfz
Ped.
Ped.
81
8
sfz
sfz
pp
Ped.
Ped.
85
8
cresc.
8
ff
Ped.
ff

Section 5
Into the twentieth century

Around 1900 three very different composers turn away from the Romantic piano: Satie with slow, bare dances; Joplin with ragtime, the syncopated piano music of America; and Debussy with harmony heard as colour.

What it asks of you

For Satie: absolute calm, an even left hand and a pedal changed on every bar. For Joplin: a strict, steady left hand ('never play ragtime fast', he wrote) under a syncopated right hand, crisp and light.

In this section

E. Satie: Gymnopédie No. 1 *(Level 7)*

E. Satie: Gymnopédie No. 3 *(Level 7)*

E. Satie: Gnossienne No. 1 *(Level 7)*

S. Joplin: The Entertainer *(Level 8)*

S. Joplin: Elite Syncopations *(Level 8)*

Gymnopédie No. 1

E. Satie (1866-1925) - Trois Gymnopédies (1888)

Level 7 · about 3 min

The first of Satie's three slow dances: a bass note on the first beat, a chord on the second, and a plain melody above. Calm and even, with a pedal change every bar.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 37, typeset by Evin Robertson (public domain).




1.
32
2.
40

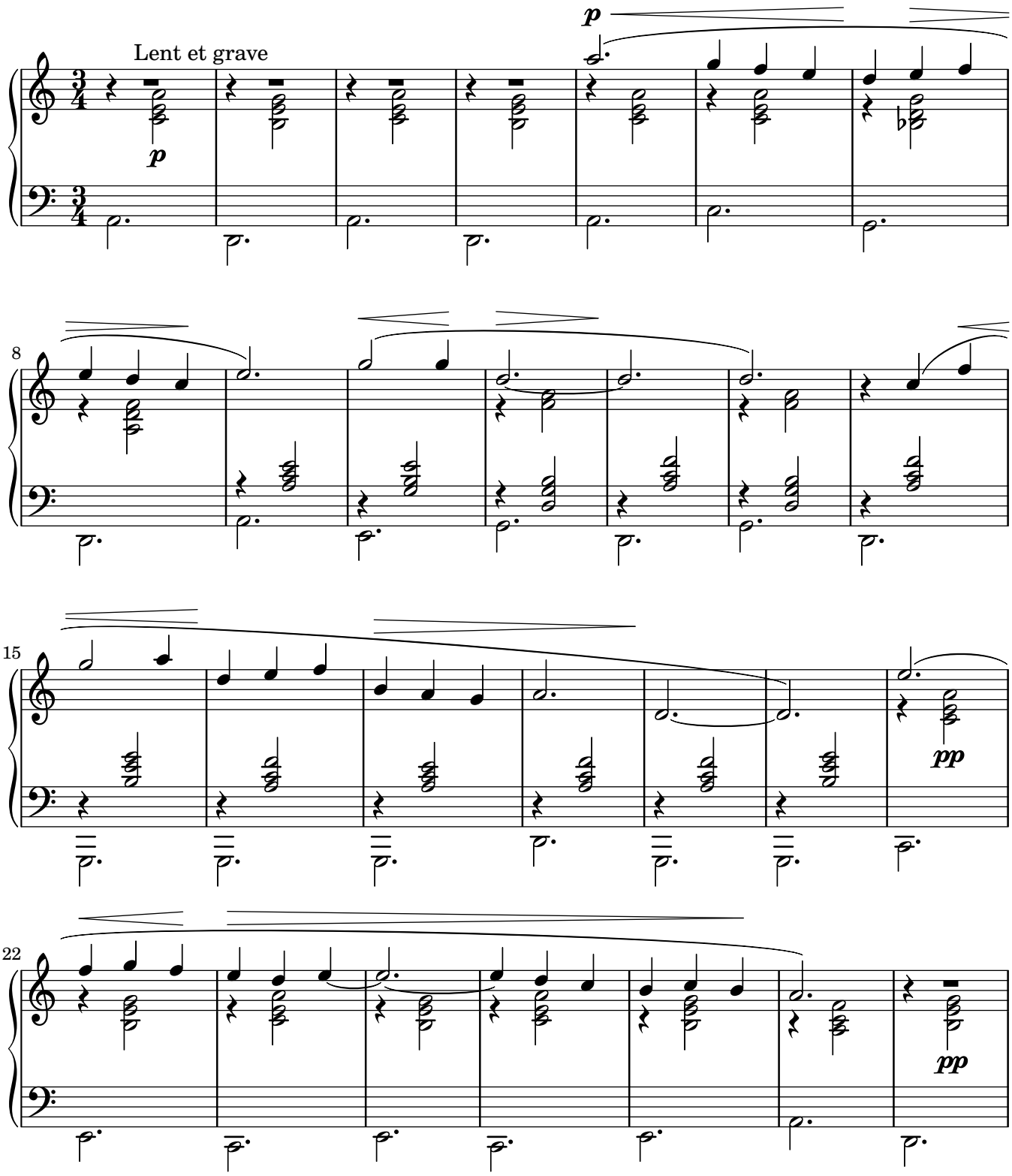
Gymnopédie No. 3

E. Satie (1866-1925) - Trois Gymnopédies (1888)

Level 7 · about 2 min

The third Gymnopédie, in the same bare style as the first: bass, chord, melody. Play it slowly and evenly; the long notes must be held through their whole value.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 39, typeset by Evin Robertson (public domain).




29
p
37
45
pp
53
pp

Gnossienne No. 1

E. Satie (1866-1925) - Trois Gnossiennes (1890)

Level 7 · about 3 min

Satie wrote it without bar lines or time signature; this edition adds bar lines. His strange instructions ('Very shining', 'Questioning', 'From the tip of the thought') are part of the music and are printed with translations. Keep the left hand's bass and chord steady under the free melody.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 2035, typeset by Knute Snortum (CC BY-SA 4.0).




34
f
40
Du bout de la pensée (From the tip of the thought)
47
53
Postulez en vous-même (Wonder about yourself)
60
Pas à Pas (Step by Step)
65



Sur la langue (On the tip of the tongue)

The Entertainer

S. Joplin (1868-1917) - A Rag Time Two Step (1902)

Level 8 · about 4 min

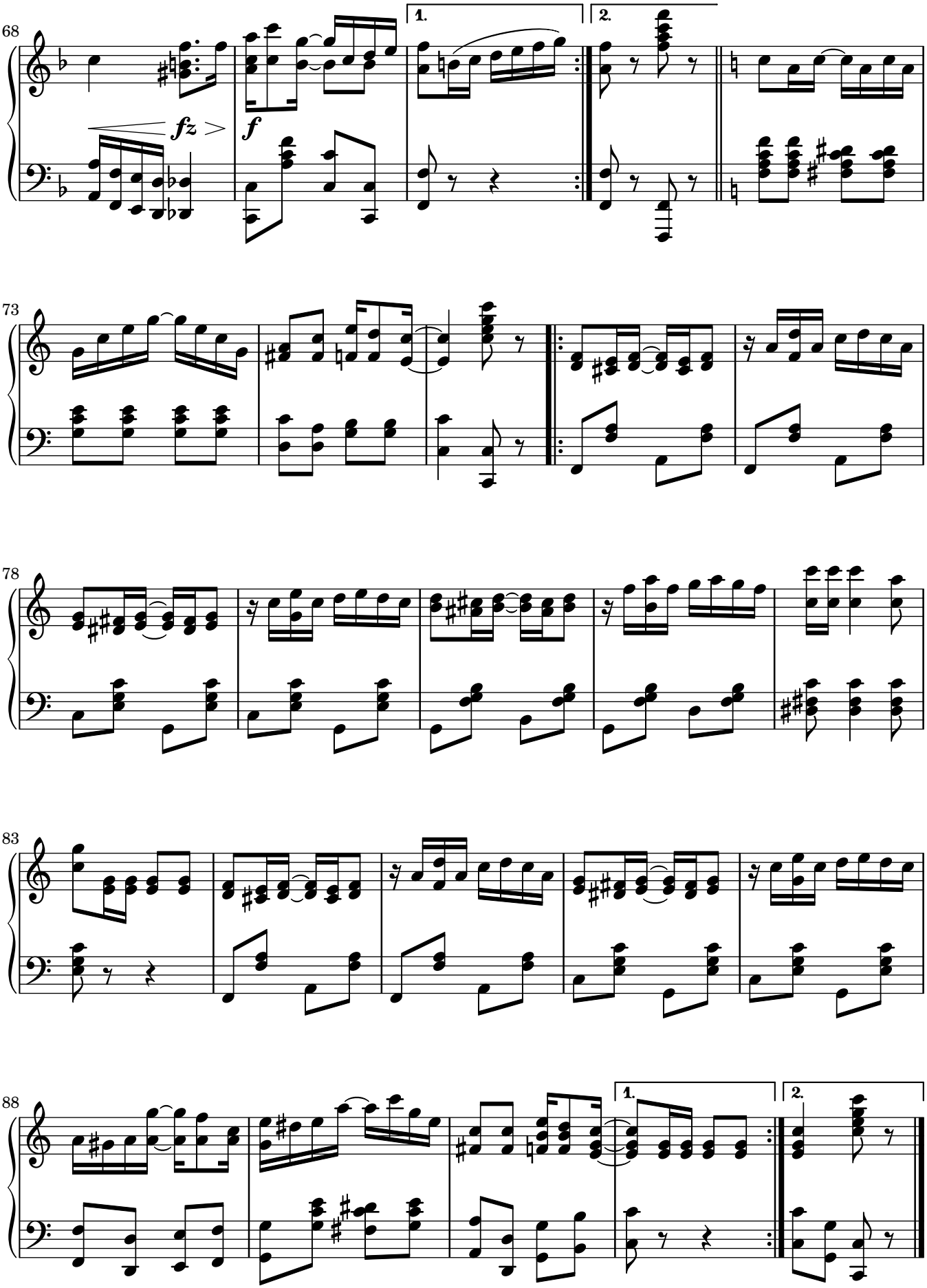
Scott Joplin, 'the King of Ragtime', published it in 1902; it became famous again through the film The Sting in 1973. An introduction and four strains (sections), each repeated. The left hand alternates bass notes and chords in strict time; Joplin marked it 'Not fast'.

Source: Mutopia Project no. 263, typeset by Chris Sawer (public domain).




21
2.
Repeat 8va
f
25
29
p
33
p
1.
8
38
2.
p
f


43
p
f
p
48
f
53
f
58
63


68
1.
2.
fz
f
73
78
83
88
1.
2.

Elite Syncopations

S. Joplin (1868-1917) - Rag (1902)

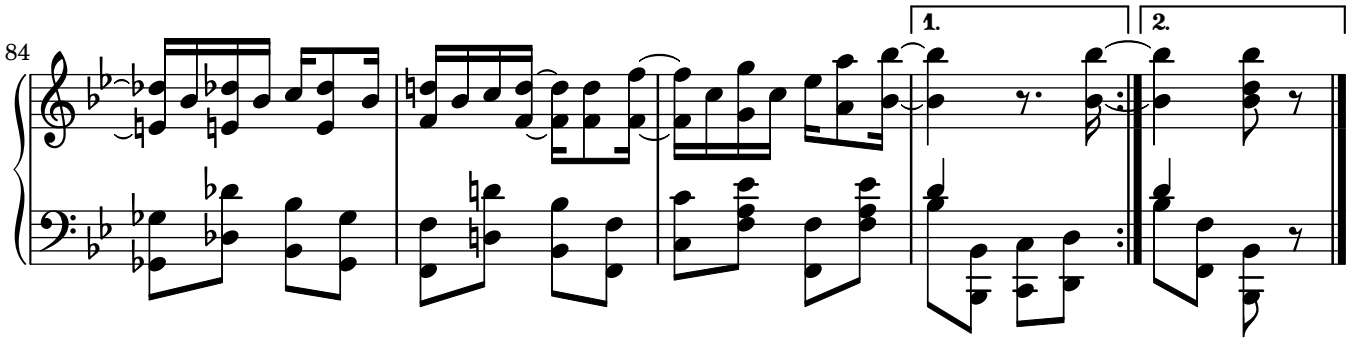
Level 8 · about 4 min

Another Joplin rag of 1902, also used in The Sting. The syncopations (accents between the beats) must be crisp against the steady left hand. 'Not fast', as Joplin always insisted.
Source: Mutopia Project no. 1540, typeset by Benjamin Bloomfield (public domain).




26
31
36
1.
2.
41
45
50


55
60
65
69
1.
2.
74
79


84
1.
2.

Pieces by level

A suggested order: start at the top of Level 7 and choose freely within a level. Mix the eras: a Baroque piece trains the fingers and the ear for voices, a Romantic one the pedal and the singing tone.

Level 7

J. S. Bach: Little Prelude in D minor, BWV 926 5
J. S. Bach: Little Prelude in C, BWV 933 7
J. S. Bach: Invention No. 1 in C, BWV 772 9
J. S. Bach: Invention No. 4 in D minor, BWV 775 11
J. S. Bach: Invention No. 8 in F, BWV 779 13
J. S. Bach: Prelude in C, BWV 846 20
J. S. Bach: Gavotte in G, BWV 816 26
G. F. Handel: Air with Variations in F 29
W. A. Mozart: Sonata in C, K. 545: I. Allegro 40
W. A. Mozart: Sonata in C, K. 545: II. Andante 46
L. van Beethoven: Für Elise 60
L. van Beethoven: Sonata in G, Op. 49 No. 2: I. Allegro ma non troppo 64
L. van Beethoven: Sonata in G, Op. 49 No. 2: II. Tempo di menuetto 68
F. Schubert: Moment musical No. 3 in F minor, D. 780 85
R. Schumann: Of Foreign Lands and Peoples, Op. 15 No. 1 100
R. Schumann: Träumerei (Dreaming), Op. 15 No. 7 101
F. Chopin: Prelude in E minor, Op. 28 No. 4 103
F. Chopin: Prelude in B minor, Op. 28 No. 6 105
F. Chopin: Prelude in A, Op. 28 No. 7 107
J. Brahms: Waltz in A-flat, Op. 39 No. 15 124
E. Satie: Gymnopédie No. 1 132
E. Satie: Gymnopédie No. 3 134
E. Satie: Gnossienne No. 1 136

Level 8

J. S. Bach: Invention No. 13 in A minor, BWV 784 15
J. S. Bach: Sinfonia No. 2 in C minor, BWV 788 17
J. S. Bach: Prelude in C minor, BWV 847 23
J. S. Bach: Aria from the Goldberg Variations, BWV 988 27
D. Scarlatti: Sonata in C minor, K. 11 31
J.-P. Rameau: Tambourin in E minor 33
J. Haydn: Sonata in G, Hob. XVI:27: III. Presto 36
W. A. Mozart: Sonata in C, K. 545: III. Rondo 50
W. A. Mozart: Fantasia in D minor, K. 397 53
L. van Beethoven: "Moonlight" Sonata, Op. 27 No. 2: I. Adagio sostenuto 73
L. van Beethoven: "Pathétique" Sonata, Op. 13: II. Adagio cantabile 78
F. Schubert: Impromptu in A-flat, D. 935 No. 2 88
J. Field: Nocturne No. 5 in B-flat, H. 37 93
F. Mendelssohn: Venetian Gondola Song in G minor, Op. 19 No. 6 96
F. Mendelssohn: Venetian Gondola Song in F-sharp minor, Op. 30 No. 6 98
F. Chopin: Prelude in D-flat 'Raindrop', Op. 28 No. 15 108
F. Chopin: Waltz in B minor, Op. 69 No. 2 113
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S. Joplin: The Entertainer 139
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